

Common Hip Injuries and Conditions

Hamstring Muscle Strain

Injury overview	These injuries are commonly caused by forceful eccentric contractions of the hamstring muscle. Athletes will have altered gait patterns with acute muscle strains.
Surgical and rehabilitative management	Surgical repairs are required only in severe cases.
Return-to-play exercise and conditioning considerations	Continue progressing overall metabolic specificity and conditioning to preserve core strength, balance, upper-body strength and power, speed, and agility. Include eccentric hamstring strengthening gradually and as part of an injury prevention program.
Return-to-play criteria	Sport-specific functional performance battery without complication (including the star balance excursion test, shark skill test, triple hop for distance, 5–10–5 test, and T-drill).
Estimated timeline	Time lost is dependent on the degree of tissue damage and the specific demands of this muscle during sports participation, lasting from a couple of days (minor) to 6 (or more) months for a complete rupture.

Adductor Muscle Strain

Injury overview	Also known as “groin strains,” these injuries are commonly caused by rapid passive lengthening combined with a forceful contraction of the hip adductors. Athletes will have altered gait patterns with acute muscle strains.
Surgical and rehabilitative management	Surgical repairs are required only in severe cases.
Return-to-play exercise and conditioning considerations	Continue progressing overall metabolic specificity and conditioning to preserve core strength, balance, upper-body strength and power, speed, and agility.
Return-to-play criteria	Sport-specific functional performance battery without complication (including the star balance excursion test, shark skill test, triple hop for distance, 5–10–5 test, and T-drill).
Estimated timeline	Time lost is dependent on the degree of tissue damage and the specific demands of this muscle during sports participation, lasting from a couple of days (minor) to 6 (or more) months for a complete rupture.

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Quadriceps Muscle Strain

Injury overview	Of the four muscles in the quadriceps muscle group, the rectus femoris crosses two joints, predisposing it to injury.
Surgical and rehabilitative management	Surgical repairs are required only in severe cases.
Return-to-play exercise and conditioning considerations	Continue progressing overall metabolic specificity and conditioning to preserve core strength, balance, upper-body strength and power, speed, and agility.
Return-to-play criteria	Sport-specific functional performance battery without complication (including the star balance excursion test, shark skill test, triple hop for distance, 5–10–5 test, and T-drill).
Estimated timeline	Time lost is dependent on the degree of tissue damage and the specific demands of this muscle during sports participation, lasting from a couple of days (minor) to 6 (or more) months for a complete rupture.

Greater Trochanter Pain Syndrome (“Bursitis”)

Injury overview	Although a direct (acute) contusion can cause this condition, it is more commonly seen as a chronic condition caused by friction between the trochanter and the bursa. This friction sometimes produces a “snapping” hip sensation, leading to pain.
Surgical and rehabilitative management	Surgery is typically not required. Rehabilitation will focus on symptom management, progressing to resisted exercise within pain-free ROM.
Return-to-play exercise and conditioning considerations	Continue progressing overall metabolic specificity and conditioning to preserve core strength, balance, upper-body strength and power, speed, and agility.
Return-to-play criteria	Sport-specific functional performance battery without complication (including the star balance excursion test, shark skill test, triple hop for distance, 5–10–5 test, and T-drill).
Estimated timeline	Time lost is dependent on the degree of tissue damage and the specific demands of this muscle during sports participation, lasting from a couple of days (minor) to 6 (or more) months for a complete rupture.

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Chronic Pubalgia ("Sports Hernia," "Athletic Hernia")

Injury overview	Chronic lower abdominal and groin pain without a true hernia. This condition often occurs in conjunction with other hip and pelvic ailments (i.e., acetabular labral tears, femoroacetabular (FA) impingement, trochanteric bursitis) and primarily affects athletes participating in activities that require repetitive turning and twisting, such as ice hockey and soccer.
Surgical and rehabilitative management	Surgical repair of the pubalgia alone has a poor success rate. However, since pubalgia is compounded by the bony formation in the hip (FA impingement), when surgical interventions correct both the pubalgia and the FA impingement, the rate of return to sport outcomes approaches 90%.
Return-to-play exercise and conditioning considerations	Continue progressing overall metabolic specificity and conditioning to preserve core strength, balance, upper-body strength and power, speed, and agility.
Return-to-play criteria	Sport-specific functional performance battery without complication (including the star balance excursion test, shark skill test, triple hop for distance, 5–10–5 test, and T-drill).
Estimated timeline	Time lost is dependent on the degree of tissue damage and the specific demands of this muscle during sports participation, lasting from a couple of days (minor) to 6 (or more) months for a complete rupture.

Piriformis Syndrome

Injury overview	Common in runners, weightlifters, and baseball/softball catchers, this condition involves muscle tightness of the piriformis muscle compressing on the sciatic nerve.
Surgical and rehabilitative management	Surgery is typically not required. Rehabilitation involves an integrated flexibility program to restore multiplanar mobility of the hip, combined with progressive core stability and balance training program.
Return-to-play exercise and conditioning considerations	Continue progressing overall metabolic specificity and conditioning to preserve core strength, balance, upper-body strength and power, speed, and agility.
Return-to-play criteria	Sport-specific functional performance battery without complication (including the star balance excursion test, shark skill test, triple hop for distance, 5–10–5 test, and T-drill).
Estimated timeline	Return to full participation generally occurs quickly. Continued maintenance is required to improve all modifiable factors contributing to faulty movement quality.